leave and had him dropped to his village in Ludhiana district under police escort. Brar also recommended Pandher's summary dismissal from service under Article 311 of the Indian Constitution. The case reached the PMO. Someone pointed out that such an action could lead Pandher to join the Akali Dal, and he wouldn't be a pliant member either.

The state CID and CBI were asked to collect evidence in order to lodge a corruption case against him. His house at his village and his government flat in New Delhi were searched and his entire service record from the day he joined the Indian Police Service was screened. As nothing incriminating was found against him, he was repatriated to his cadre, Manipur, in early 1985. In due course he became director general of police, Manipur, and finally retired honourably as DG, Bureau of Police Research and Development (BPRD) on 30 April 1998 with the additional charge of NSG.

Pandher laments that despite promises made in the Akali Dal's election manifesto during the 1997 state elections, of appointing a commission to go into the truth behind Operation Blue Star, no such action was taken by them even though the Akali Dal was in power in Punjab from 1997 to 2002 and then again from 2007 to 2017. [10]

The operation begins

On the night of 3 June, the army surrounded thirty-seven gurudwaras in Punjab to flush out suspected Sikh militants hiding there. Other than at Gurudwara Dukh Niwaran in Patiala, the army was met with hardly any resistance. As was the case with the Golden Temple, the Patiala operation too was commanded by a clean-shaven Sikh, Maj. Gen. Gurdial Singh. According to the army's official version, twenty persons were killed in that operation, but doctors at the Government Rajendra Hospital, Patiala, were reportedly of the view that at least fifty-six had died.

By the night of 4 June, practically all gurudwaras outside Amritsar were cleared of militants, and the army had arrested most of them and confiscated their weapons. However, the army was disappointed by the small number of militants they had captured or